
TOMMASO MINOLA

Department of Management, Information and Production Engineering
and Center for Young and Family Enterprise
University of Bergamo

DANIELE RADICI

Innovation-LAB

IMPRENDITORIALITÀ, INNOVAZIONE E MARKETING

Course Details and Contents



**UNIVERSITÀ
DEGLI STUDI
DI BERGAMO**

Details and contents

- Course name **Imprenditorialità, Innovazione e Marketing**
(code 37171, 6 ECTS)
- Course term February, 27th 2026 – June, 5th 2026
- Course day Friday from 9am to 1pm
- e-learning <https://elearning15.unibg.it/course/view.php?id=8163>
- Social Strategic Management & Entrepreneurship @UniBG



Lectures

Introduction to
entrepreneurship [M1]

Tools and methods for idea
generation and validation [M2]

Sustainability and growth [M3]

Labs

Talks and Cases [M1]

Idea generation [M2]

Idea validation [M3]

Module 1: March Module 2: April Module 3: May

- **Lectures** introduce to the theory of entrepreneurship, including the language of entrepreneurship, creativity and innovation, intrapreneurship, and learning from both successful and unsuccessful digital ventures.
- Tools regarding how to design and launch **entrepreneurial strategy** or **transformation** project will be deeply illustrated
- Readings, lectures, talks, and live discussions will be used to explore these and related issues.

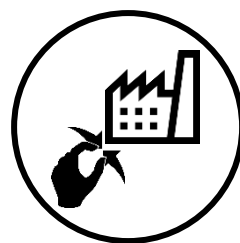
- Module 1 – Foundations of entrepreneurship (March)
 - Introduction and entrepreneurial paradigms
 - Entrepreneurship as a career choice
 - Actors, resources and ecosystems in entrepreneurship
 - Entrepreneurship and economic development
- Module 2 - 3 – Opportunity assessment and development (April & May)
 - Design Thinking
 - Customer development; Problem-Solution fit; Problem Definition
 - Value Proposition; Competitive analysis; Product-Market fit; Riskiest Assumptions
 - Prototyping & Designing an MVP
 - Business Model Design
 - Testing & Validating
 - Financing SMEs
 - Growth sustainable SMEs

- The **Entrepreneurial Talks** represent an opportunity to understand how entrepreneurship theory relates to practice. They supplement theory with examples from the real-life experience of individual entrepreneurs, startupper and managers who practice the entrepreneurial skills necessary to compete in a global complex economy. The aim is to foster students' **entrepreneurial skills** through a deep debate with the entrepreneurs.
- The Entrepreneurial Talks will focus on the **growth and development** of small and medium sized enterprises (**SMEs**). The guests will be asked to devote attention especially on the processes that support the strategic innovation of the company.



- The **Project Work & Validation Labs** are aimed to train skills and apply tools to develop and test a new entrepreneurial idea **in close interaction with local SMEs**.
 - **Project Work Labs**, where students will use tools for developing their own business model and planning the launch of the business; this includes identifying and analyzing customer demand, defining the market and growth potential and formalizing all this insights and information in a structured document. Project works includes collaboration with local SMEs.
 - **Validation Labs**, where students will be trained to the use of digital tools for the generation, crafting, prototyping, market validation, and scaling of business ideas.

**WHY DOES
IT MATTER?**



SMEs

European Commission, 2019



25
million of SMEs

99%
*of NFBS
enterprises*

- **Attending the course is strongly recommended.** Students are encouraged to participate to every class.
- The course is structured to be interactive with the class participants.
Proactive participation is appreciated
- Contributions to discussion (in class and/or through social networks) and ideas from the students are encouraged. Informed and engaged participation is of paramount importance and welcome from everyone. Students are also strongly invited to debate about the topics, experiment new ideas and share links to real cases.
- **Active learning** (quiz, group discussion, participation)



Faculty

Name: Tommaso Minola, PhD

Profession: Full Professor at the University of Bergamo and co-founder of CYFE.

Research interests: University- and family-entrepreneurship, especially in the domain of new technologies. His work has been published in several established academic journals in entrepreneurship and innovation.

Work experience: He is scientific director of the *Start Cup* and *CREO* programs. Previously, he managed a hi-tech incubator at Politecnico di Milano and helped successfully launch a number of technological start-ups.

“A company in a virtual world is a company in a world of possibilities and this is precisely why it is exciting, because the industrial world - seen in a positive way - is not already determined. There are always many more possibilities than we imagine!”

(François Michelin)



Name: Daniele Radici

Profession: Consultant & Professor

Work Experience:

- InnovationLAB® founder
- Talent Garden Innovation School
- Università degli Studi di Bergamo
- Politecnico di Milano

Favorite entrepreneur: Steve Jobs, for his unique vision and his "less-is-more" approach





Name: Andrea Buratti

Profession: Post-doc Researcher.

Work experience:

- Academia: University of Bergamo, member of CYFE
- Industry: Accenture

Research interests: Innovation, Purpose, Business model

Favorite Entrepreneur: Adriano Olivetti, for his role in the society and his “ahead-of-time vision”.

In the course, he will be responsible for:

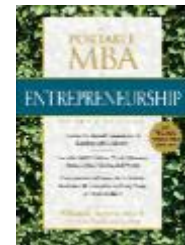
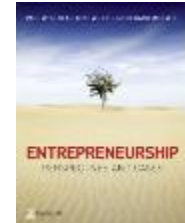
- Course organization; Teamwork management
- Moodle platform; Class communication

Email is: andrea.buratti@unibg.it

Resources

- Online resources are available to the students enrolled on the course through the Moodle platform
 - Lessons
 - Case studies / videos
 - Reference material (scientific papers, reports, podcasts, interviews, etc.)
 - Lectures by visiting executives (entrepreneurs, managers, etc.)
 - Information about lessons, conferences, events, etc.
- Students are invited to join the Facebook Group “Strategic Management & Entrepreneurship @UniBG” to share information and posts about the main topics of the course
 - www.facebook.com/groups/strategicmanagementunibg/

- Imprenditorialità
J.R. Bessant, J. Tidd
Il Mulino, ISBN 978-88-15-28495-2
- Entrepreneurship: Perspectives and Cases
P. Westhead, G. McElwee, M. Wright
Prentice Hall, ISBN 978-0-27372-613-5
- The portable MBA in Entrepreneurship
W.D. Bygrave, A. Zacharakis
John Wiley, ISBN 978-0-470-48131-8
- Business model generation: a handbook for visionaries,
game changers, and challengers
A. Osterwalder, Y. Pigneur
John Wiley, ISBN 978-2-8399-0580-0



- Business model innovation strategy: Transformational concepts and tools for entrepreneurial leaders.
Amit, R., & Zott, C. (2020).
John Wiley & Sons.
- The Digital Transformation Roadmap: Rebuild Your Organization for Continuous Change.
Rogers, D. (2023).
Columbia University Press.
- Digital entrepreneurship: Impact on business and society.
Soltanifar, M., Hughes, M., & Göcke, L. (2021).
Springer Nature.
https://library.oapen.org/bitstream/handle/20.500.12657/47272/10.1007_978-3-030-53914-6.pdf?sequence=1

Exams and Course policies

- The exam will cover the entire course and require you to demonstrate your mastery of the topics, tools and frameworks covered in this course through the preparation and the presentation of a project work involving the generation and validation of **an innovative entrepreneurial idea** and the design of **a business model**.
- The grading plan will be as follows:
 - Assignment 1 (*individual*) : 20% (up to 6 points)
 - Assignment 2 (Project Work, *team*) : 80% (up to 24 points)
 - Proactive participation (*individual*) : +10% (up to +3 points)
- The project work is assigned on **student groups** basis formed by the faculty (students' proposals will be evaluated).
Each team must be composed of **4-5 students according to the project work's policy**.
Each group must appoint a **leader** in charge of communicating with the faculty

- The project work is practically-oriented and the final output is a **validated business model** that the students must write. The project work will require to apply tools and notions to a real business. The project work will be prepared in the meantime during the course.
- The project work will be discussed within a final in-class presentation to the faculty. The students could pitch their ideas to a panel of entrepreneurs, angel investors and venture capitalists. The panel will influence the final grade.
- In cooperation with the **Center for Young and Family Enterprise (CYFE)** the best project works will be eligible to the participation to several **innovation competitions in Italy** (e.g., StartCup), and concur for awards, grants and initiatives to support the startup.

- The project work must be **original**. Students never use others' work and present it as their own. References shall always be cited. In case of plagiarism the entire exam will be rejected.
- Each student of the group will put his/her effort to make sure that his/her contribution and presentation will be comparable among the members. Each team member will be selected by the Faculty to present different parts of the business model. **Each student may be assigned a different score.**
- The project work comprehensive package will be sent to the Faculty **one week before the exam official date** through cloud downloading.
- Based on the project work topics and domain, the Faculty may pose a question to each student within the group, on matters and subjects taken from the Theory module. The answers influence the final evaluation, individually.

- Groups can be of **4-5 people**.
- **Andrea Buratti** will post on Moodle a link with a Google Form to collect students' data and create groups according to the project's work policy.
- The Faculty will make the final decision on group compositions.

- First: *individual* assignment
 - At the end of Module 1
 - Application of theories illustrated in M1 to assess the entrepreneurial predisposition of oneself or known individuals (e.g., family and friends)
- Second: *group* assignment
 - At the end of Module 3
 - Presentation of the business model (project work) obtained from idea validation



- The exam will be based on the syllabus for non attending students (to be found in Moodle). The syllabus includes:
 - The reference text “Entrepreneurship: Perspectives and Cases” (P. Westhead, G. McElwee, M. Wright)
 - Scientific material from published sources (chapters and journal articles)
 - Online resources (lectured materials, cases and discussions).
- The exam will be performed on an individual basis and modality depends on the contingent situation.

- Attendance
 - Attendance is useful requirement for an effective class discussion and team-based course.
 - All the students are members of a learning community, so a professional behavior is expected. Please be on time for the class and be respectful of others' viewpoints even if in disagreement with them.
- Computer and mobile phone
 - Some sessions will require that the team has access to a computer or mobile devices to access the internet. The use of electronic devices other than for the class activities is not appropriate.
- Kick-out option
 - Although it generally doesn't apply, team members have the right to determine whether to kick “non-performers” out of the team. To exercise the option, the team leader has to send an e-mail to andrea.buratti@unibg.it, confirmed by the members, requesting the kick-out. Students who are excluded from the team are responsible for finding a new team.

Source: Adaptation from the Syllabus, Strategic Management & Business Policy, prof. Jing Sun, Wayne State University

- Academic integrity
 - The university policies regarding plagiarism, cheating and similar activities will be pursued as appropriate. Downloading or use of material obtained from an on-line site without proper citation is plagiarism. Citing sources properly is necessary to demonstrate where your information is coming from. It also helps keep you from accidentally plagiarizing.
- Grade disputes
 - Although generally it doesn't happen, grade disputes are handled in writing. Students are invited to submit a memo to [andrea.buratti @unibg.it](mailto:andrea.buratti@unibg.it) describing the disputed item and why they feel the grade was incorrect. Grading errors are possible, but please be aware that errors can be overly generous as well as overly harsh. Accordingly, the grade on the remarked assignment may stay the same, be increased, or be decreased. There are no extra credit assignments or other supplementary options for improving a course grade.

Source: Adaptation from the Syllabus, Strategic Management & Business Policy, prof. Jing Sun, Wayne State University

- Submissions constitute public disclosure: if you've got an amazing secret, please not disclose it
- Do not write “*confidential*” or “*proprietary*” on your assignments or submitted plans
- We will freely distribute submitted plans to your classmates
- This is an academic environment, **information is free**, and **we have no walls**. You have no stake to a claim in a company because of your work in this class.
- No “Winklevoss effect” here
- Implicit permission is given to use in future classes/handbook

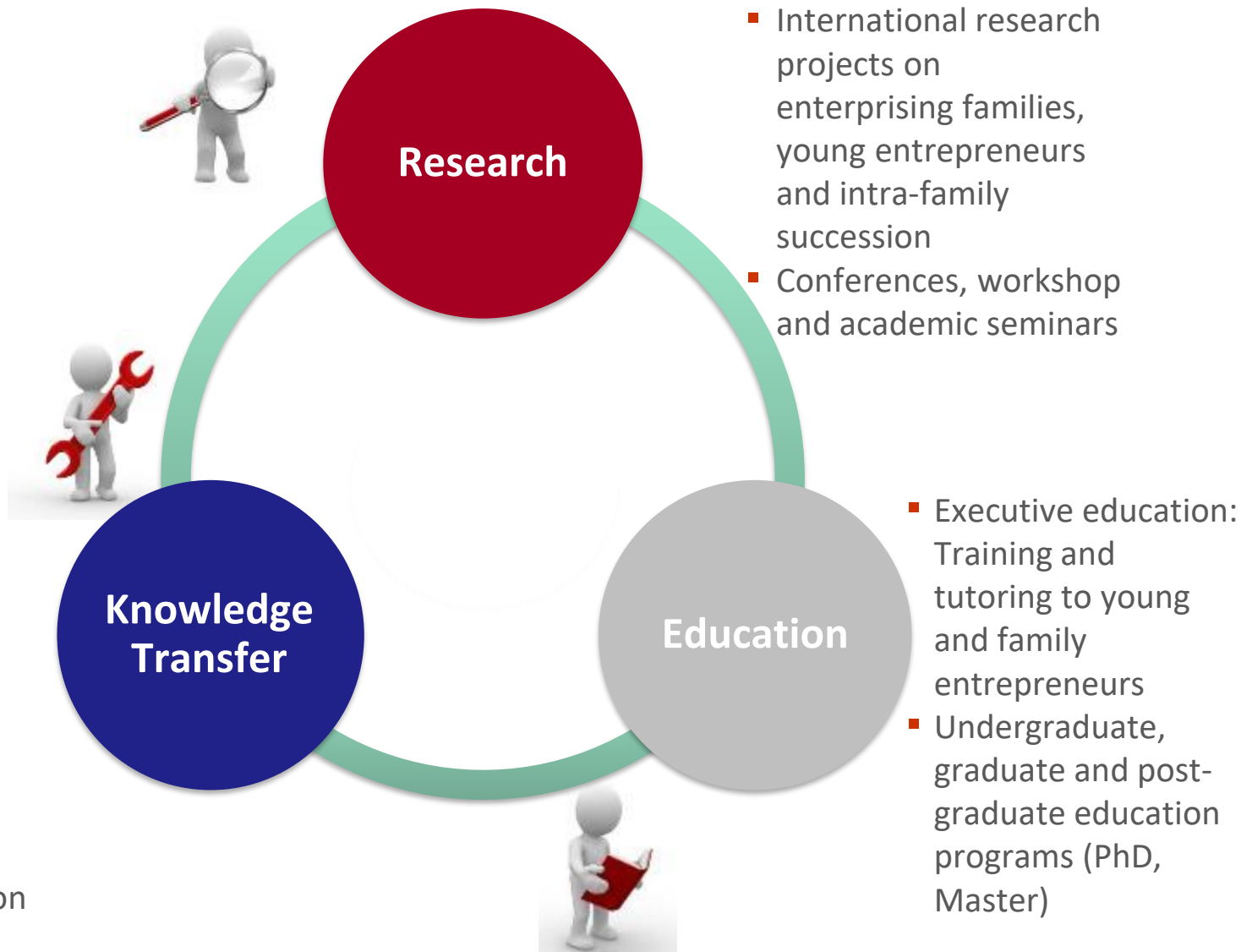
Reference : New Enterprises, MIT Open Course 15.390



CYFE (Center for Young and Family Enterprise) is a Research Center of the University of Bergamo.

- ... which explores and fosters ***entrepreneurial culture*** at individual, organizational, and societal level.
- ... which focuses on entrepreneurship in both new ventures and incumbents, with a special interest for family businesses.

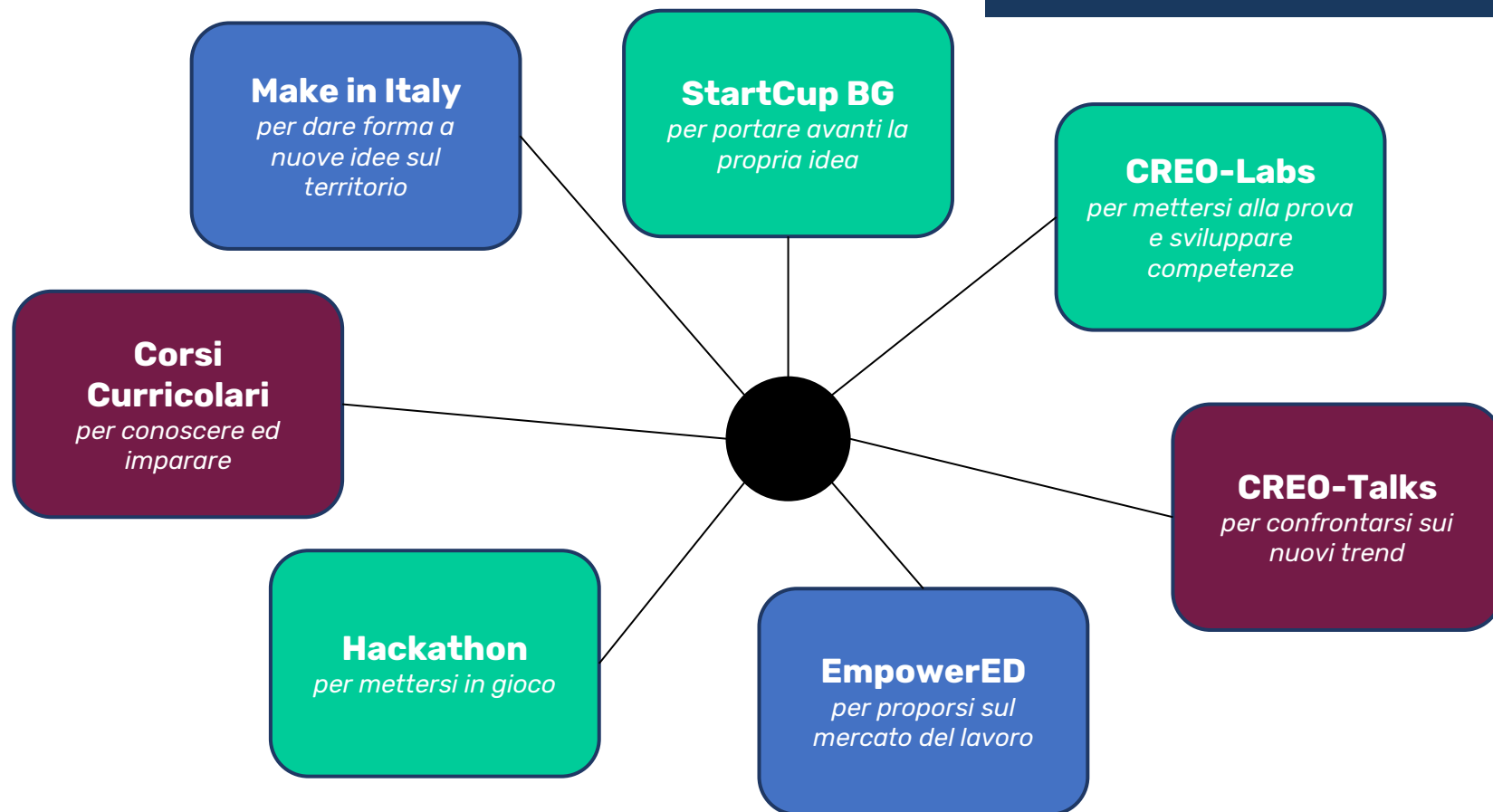




What is CREO?

CREO

Competencies and
Resources for
Entrepreneurial
Orientation



- **CREO** (*Competencies and Resources for Entrepreneurial Orientation*) is the **new initiative of the University of Bergamo** that represents a multidimensional program aiming to enrich students, professors and researchers, as well as foster collaboration with local businesses and organizations.
- For students, CREO aims to offer a **complete training path that stimulates their transversal skills** that are fundamental for the modern world, such as creativity, proactiveness, the spirit of adaptation, and a sense of responsibility. Students are encouraged to develop innovative projects, think critically, and propose original solutions to the challenges of the contemporary world through learning by doing activities and new tools and courses that require the involvement of the different disciplinary areas of the University.
- CREO's fundamental philosophy is to put **the person at the center of the innovation process**, recognizing that it is individuals with their ideas and commitment who drive change and create value in society. CREO aims to be a driver of change and development for both the university and the surrounding community, promoting a culture of innovation and collaboration that can inspire and guide future generations.

- CREO has been designed under the **change of paradigm** that the University of Bergamo is trying to achieve, moving toward an Entrepreneurial University orientation, and tries to concretely enact such change.
- In early March, in conjunction with the launch of the [four CREO-LABs](#) (i.e., the first CREO pillars), a wide-audience event will take place at the University of Bergamo; students, academics and actors of the local entrepreneurial and innovation ecosystems will be invited.
- Videos of pilots CREO-Labs (called HC.LAB): [here](#)

What is Start Cup?

Part of CREO, **Start Cup Bergamo** is the “inter-curricular” entrepreneurial training program promoted by the University of Bergamo, that aims to train all the aspiring entrepreneurs supporting them in the development of their business idea, till entering the market. Start Cup Bergamo is open to the students of our University, and it is completely free-of-charge.



Start Cup Bergamo is divided into **two main parts**:

- **Start Cup School**: Entrepreneurial learning through meetings and lectures supported by local entrepreneurs as mentors
- **Start Cup Competition**: A contest where the business ideas are presented to academics, investors and entrepreneurs to be evaluated and granted

Watch the past final events here:

2014



2015



2016



2017



2018



2019





Entrepreneurship, Innovation and Marketing (37171)



PREMIO INVITALIA PER L'IMPRENDITORIALITÀ



AIDEA

<https://www.laboratorioimprenditorialita.it/sp/regolamento.3sp>

The idea needs to be on the **Green Economy**

Interested in a thesis on these topics?

If you are interested in writing a thesis on themes such as:

- Innovative startups
- University-based entrepreneurship
- Entrepreneurial strategies & dynamics, with a focus on family business

Send your application to the below link including the following documents:

- Name, surname, ID number
- Degree course and year
- Current average grade of exams and missing exams
- Target graduation time
- Willingness to possibly perform the thesis in pairs
- Topic and possible research question of interest
- Motivation to carry out the thesis in the area indicated
- Skills relevant for carrying out the thesis

Link: <https://forms.gle/jrZDdvuusHQfdy426>

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